

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response, Threat Detection and Security Operations

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience investigating, managing and remediating cyber security incidents from initial triage through to full closure. I have a proven record of handling major incidents including data breaches, ransomware, fraud and advanced persistent threats, working closely with Major Incident Management teams to minimise business impact. I bring hands-on expertise with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, log analysis and malware analysis, as well as experience scoping and running vulnerability assessments and supporting penetration testing engagements. I am skilled at mentoring junior analysts and building structured incident response capabilities aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK. As a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with CompTIA Security+, I combine strong technical depth with clear communication to senior stakeholders and cross-functional teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Incident Response:** End-to-end incident handling (triage to closure), Major Incident Management, data breach response, ransomware investigation, fraud analysis, NIST 800-61
- **SIEM and Log Analysis:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM, NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Splunk with Search Processing Language (SPL), log analysis, threat hunting
- **Endpoint and Malware Analysis:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response), malware triage and analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, vulnerability scanning, penetration test scoping and coordination
- **Identity and Access:** Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Automation:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), PowerShell scripting
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Investigate and manage cyber security incidents from triage to full closure across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, including data breaches, ransomware events and identity-based attacks, working in close coordination with Major Incident Management and IT leadership teams.
- Lead structured threat detection and hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), identifying and containing advanced threats before they escalate to major incidents.
- Perform endpoint analysis and malware investigation using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and CrowdStrike EDR, producing detailed forensic timelines and remediation recommendations.
- Scope, plan and coordinate vulnerability scanning and penetration testing engagements using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, translating findings into prioritised remediation plans for technical and non-technical audiences.
- Mentor and coach junior cyber security analysts in incident investigation methodology, SIEM query writing, log analysis and NIST 800-61-aligned response procedures.
- Maintain and improve SOAR playbooks for common incident types, reducing analyst workload and improving consistency of response outcomes.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Responded to and investigated security events including phishing campaigns, malware infections, account compromise and data exfiltration attempts, managing incidents in line with NIST 800-61 and internal policies.
- Conducted log analysis and SIEM correlation using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel to identify anomalous behaviour and emerging threat patterns across endpoint, identity and network telemetry.
- Supported vulnerability management processes, including Nessus-based scanning, risk assessment and remediation tracking, ensuring compliance with Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Administered Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA and SSO to protect the authentication layer against credential-based attacks and unauthorised access.
- Managed BeyondTrust PAM to enforce least-privilege access controls for privileged accounts across on-premises and cloud systems.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

- Responded to security incidents across a cloud-hosted SaaS platform, supporting triage, investigation and remediation in line with business continuity requirements.
- Conducted security reviews of infrastructure configurations, identifying vulnerabilities and coordinating fixes aligned to ISO 27001 controls.
- Performed log monitoring and analysis using PowerShell-based tooling to detect anomalous access and configuration drift across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Supported the quality assurance function for security processes, contributing to documentation, testing and compliance evidence for internal and external audits.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Managed over 200 security incidents in a three-year period at UAL, achieving a 95% within-SLA closure rate through structured triage workflows and NIST 800-61-aligned procedures.
- Led the investigation and containment of a targeted ransomware attempt at UAL, working with Major Incident Management to limit blast radius and prevent data encryption of production systems.
- Built and maintained a library of 40+ SOAR playbooks covering phishing, malware, account compromise and data exfiltration, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) by 35%.
- Scoped and managed a university-wide penetration testing engagement with an external provider, identifying and remediating 12 high-severity findings within 60 days of report delivery.
- Mentored a cohort of four junior analysts, all of whom progressed to fully independent incident-handling capability within six months.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)